FOR AFFILIATES, NETWORK MARKETERS & SMALL BUSINESS

FUNNELS WITHOUT THE FEES

How to Build Your Email List and Sell Online Without Expensive, Technical Software



✓ Start free ✓ No tech skills ✓ A 30-day plan

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Funnels Without the Fees

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Two good tools, two different jobs

Systeme.io and DFY Funnels are both affordable, beginner-friendly funnel platforms, but they are built for different jobs. DFY Funnels is the simplest, lowest-cost way to build an email list and promote offers. Systeme.io is an all-in-one platform for selling your own products, courses and memberships.

I use both in my own business. This guide explains what each one does, what it costs, and who it suits, so you can pick the one that fits where your business is today. You may find, as I did, that using both makes sense.

Disclosure: I earn a commission if you join or upgrade through the links in this guide, at no extra cost to you. This guide is my own and is not affiliated with or endorsed by Systeme.io or DFY Funnels.

Why most funnel platforms are a hard start

The big-name funnel platforms are powerful, but they start at $97 a month or more, and none has a permanent free plan. They are built for established marketers and agencies, so a beginner faces a steep learning curve before the first lead comes in.

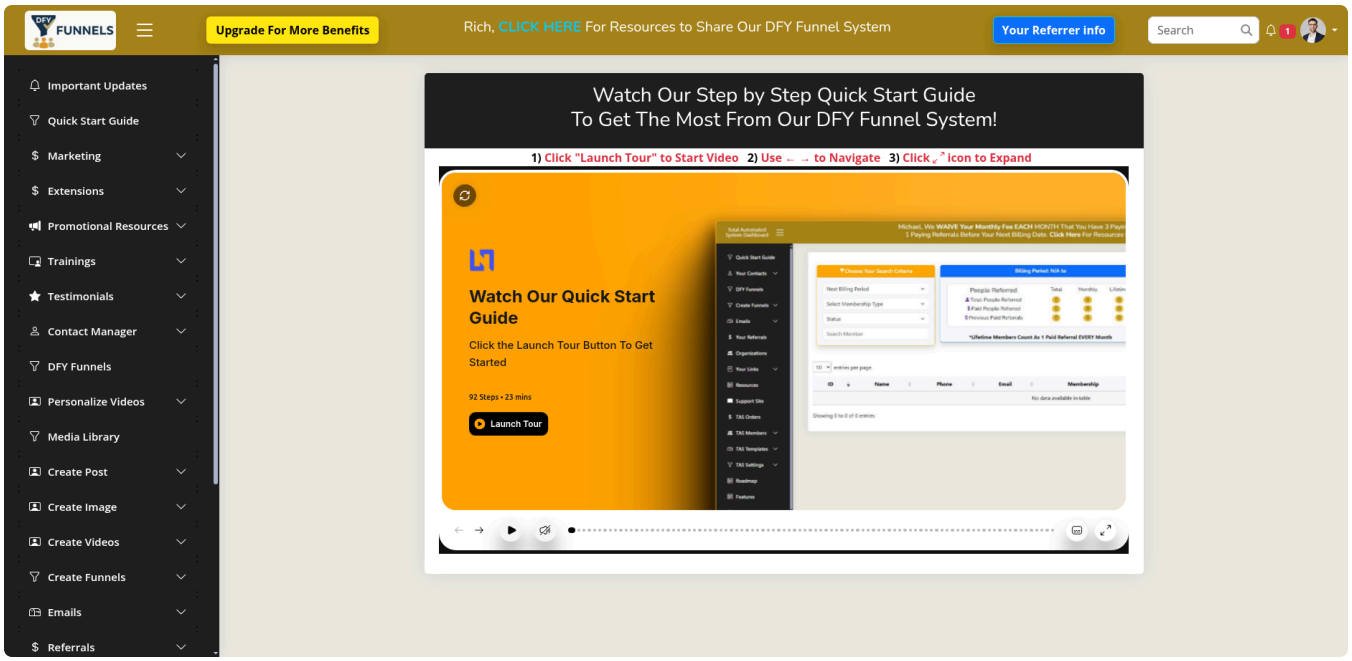
Platform	Entry price (USD/month)	Free plan	Built mainly for
ClickFunnels	$97 (Launch); $197 and $297 tiers	No (14-day trial)	Marketers running full sales funnels
GoHighLevel	$97 (Starter); $297 and $497 tiers	No (14-day trial)	Marketing agencies managing clients
Kajabi	$179 monthly ($143 billed yearly)	No	Established course creators

These tools also add usage charges. ClickFunnels and GoHighLevel both bill email sending at about $0.675 per 1,000 emails on top of the plan. For someone who simply wants to capture leads and follow up by email, that is a lot of cost and setup for the job.

DFY Funnels and Systeme.io take a different approach: both let you start free and build without technical skill.

DFY Funnels: the easiest way to build your list

DFY Funnels ("Done For You") is a free-to-start lead system that captures leads and follows up by email automatically. It is built for affiliate marketers, network marketers and home-business owners who want leads without learning funnel software. You plug in the link you want to promote, and the system does the rest.



My DFY Funnels members area. New members start with a 23-minute guided Quick Start tour.

What it does

- **Funnels without building:** done-for-you funnels are ready to use, and a simple builder lets you add video, images and countdown timers. No programming needed.
- **Free gifts that capture more leads:** "Incentives" deliver a freebie when someone opts in, which lifts sign-ups.

- **Automatic follow-up:** email campaigns with a set delay between each email, sent automatically on opt-in. Done-for-you emails are included, and an AI helper writes your own.
- **A 30-day blueprint:** new members get one proven tip by email each day for 30 days.
- **Contact manager:** new leads land automatically, with groups, notes and reminders. You can also upload an existing list.
- **Content tools:** AI help for social posts, images and short videos, including personalized videos that show a prospect's name.
- **Training:** live weekly training sessions, recorded and searchable.
- **Promote anything:** your network marketing company, an affiliate offer, your own product or a local business.

A done-for-you content library

DFY Funnels hands you ready-made marketing content, so you always have something to post or send. The library includes:

- Your personal DFY link and a webinar you can share
- Reels and videos
- DM messages for starting conversations
- Value posts, story posts and curiosity posts
- Email swipes you can send as-is or adapt
- Articles, podcasts and executive summaries
- Social media images, banners and Facebook covers

For a beginner, this solves the hardest daily question: "What do I post today?"

Extensions that automate outreach

Four extensions, managed from one Extension Dashboard, handle the repetitive parts of prospecting:

- **Lead Closer CRM:** imports your Facebook contacts and lets you send broadcast messages and follow up in one place.
- **Lead Prospector:** a Chrome extension that runs Facebook group outreach as organized campaigns. It gathers public member profiles from a group, then sends friend requests and personalized messages (using first names and custom images) with daily limits, delays and pause controls. It is included in the 14-day trial and then requires the paid plan. Facebook limits automated activity, so keep daily limits low and messages genuinely personal to protect your account.

- **Auto Commentor:** replies automatically to comments on your posts, so no one is left waiting.
- **Birthday Greeter:** sends birthday wishes automatically, which opens friendly conversations.

Free training

DFY Funnels runs a free live Lead Generation Masterclass on Zoom. Attendees get a done-for-you lead funnel and a done-for-you 30-day email campaign that educates their leads about their business, plus hands-on training in generating leads during the session, with time for questions. Masterclasses run on scheduled dates, and registering through my link sends you the date, the Zoom link and the code you need to claim your done-for-you funnel and emails. Members also get live weekly training, recorded, transcribed and searchable in the members area, and a 23-minute guided Quick Start tour inside the dashboard.

What it costs

The basic system is free forever, and new members get 14 days of full access with no credit card. The upgraded monthly plan is $29.97 and unlocks many more funnels and email campaigns. That fee is waived any month you have three paying referrals, and they can be the same three people every month. Since you can give the free system away to anyone, reaching three is very achievable. A lifetime option is $497.

Why you might choose it

- You want to start building an email list today, for free.
- You promote affiliate offers or a network marketing business.
- You do not want to learn technical software.
- You want follow-up emails already written for you.

I have used DFY Funnels and its predecessor to promote affiliate offers and to sell memberships to businesses such as real estate agents. It is the simplest list-building system I have found.

DFY Funnels is focused on leads and email. It does not take payments or host courses, so if you sell your own products you will pair it with a checkout tool on your website or use Systeme.io.

Systeme.io: everything you need to sell your own products

Systeme.io is an all-in-one platform for selling your own products: funnels, email, online courses, checkout and an affiliate program in one account. It suits authors, coaches, course creators and anyone with something of their own to sell. It replaces several separate tools at a fraction of what the big platforms charge.

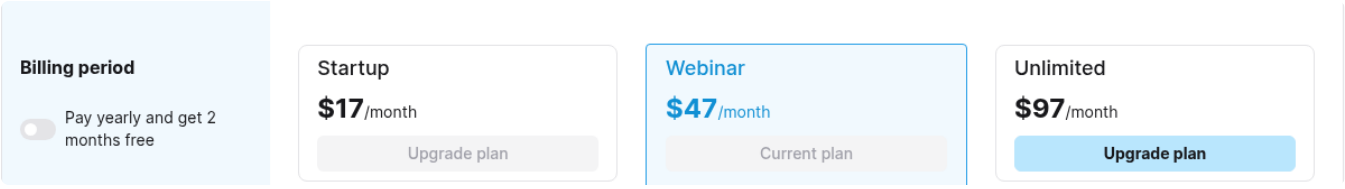
What it does

- **Sales funnels and websites:** opt-in pages, sales pages, upsells and order bumps, built with drag-and-drop.
- **Email marketing:** broadcasts, sequences and automation rules, with unlimited email sends on every plan.
- **Online courses and communities:** host courses with unlimited students on paid plans.
- **Checkout and payments:** sell products and collect payment through Stripe or PayPal. Systeme.io takes 0% of your sales.
- **Your own affiliate program:** let others promote your products for a commission you set.
- **Blogs, webinars and more:** a built-in blog, evergreen webinars on higher plans, coupons and A/B testing.

Free training

Systeme.io offers two free video courses, each with an official certificate when you finish. The Systeme.io Certification covers every feature in 28 videos, with a short knowledge test after each section. The Funnel Builder Certification teaches funnel-building in 17 videos and includes ready-to-use resources: a sales funnel, a lead magnet ebook and a link-in-bio template. After you sign up, look for both under the Student Dashboard in your account. A certificate is also useful if you want to offer funnel-building services to clients.

What it costs (US dollars, October 2026; full details are under Pricing in the Systeme.io menu)



The plan page inside my own Systeme.io account.

Plan	Monthly	Contacts	Sales funnels	Courses
Free	$0	2,000	3	1
Startup	$17	5,000	10	5
Webinar	$47	10,000	50	20
Unlimited	$97	Unlimited	Unlimited	Unlimited

Paying yearly gives two months free. The free plan has no time limit and needs no credit card.

Why you might choose it

- You have your own ebook, course, coaching or membership to sell.
- You want payments, delivery and email follow-up in one place.
- You want to recruit affiliates to sell for you.
- You want room to grow without switching platforms later.

I run my own courses and email funnel on Systeme.io. It took time to set up, but it does everything in one place, and I would not want to rebuild it elsewhere.

Side by side

Feature	DFY Funnels	Systeme.io
Free to start	Yes, free forever	Yes, free forever
Paid options	Monthly upgrade (free with 3 referrals) or $497 lifetime	$17, $47 or $97 a month
Done-for-you funnels and emails	Yes	Templates; you write your own emails
Lead capture pages	Yes	Yes
Automated email follow-up	Yes	Yes
Free-gift delivery on opt-in	Yes	Yes

Feature	DFY Funnels	Systeme.io
Contact manager	Yes, with notes and reminders	Yes, with tags
AI writing, image and video tools	Yes	AI writing help
Checkout and payments	No	Yes, 0% fees
Online courses and memberships	No	Yes
Your own affiliate program	No	Yes
Blog and website	No	Yes
Live weekly training	Yes	Help centre and tutorials
Learning curve	Very low	Low to moderate
Best for	Affiliates and network marketers building a list	Selling your own products

Which one fits you

Choose by what you sell: other people's offers point to DFY Funnels, your own products point to Systeme.io, and many businesses do well with both.

- **You promote affiliate offers or a network marketing company:** start with DFY Funnels. It captures leads and follows up for you, at no cost.
- **You have an ebook, course or coaching program to sell:** start with Systeme.io. Checkout, delivery and email all live in one account.
- **You are brand new and unsure:** both are free to start. Open DFY Funnels to begin building a list now, and add Systeme.io when you have a product of your own.
- **You want both:** use DFY Funnels to build your list and promote offers, and Systeme.io to sell and deliver your own products. That is how I run my business. It keeps my Systeme.io plan small while DFY Funnels does the list-building.

How a lead funnel actually works

Every funnel, on any platform, does four jobs in order. Once you see them, the tools stop feeling complicated.

1. **Attract:** someone sees your post, video, pin or message and clicks your link.
2. **Capture:** they land on a short page offering a free gift in exchange for their name and email.
3. **Nurture:** a series of follow-up emails delivers the gift, builds trust and teaches something useful.
4. **Offer:** once trust is built, you invite them to buy, join or upgrade.

Most beginners skip straight to step 4 and wonder why no one buys. People rarely buy from a stranger on the first visit. The follow-up emails in step 3 do most of the selling, which is why both DFY Funnels and Systeme.io automate them.

Your email list is the one marketing asset you own. Social platforms change their rules and reach, but your list stays with you, and you can reach it any day you choose.

Choose a free gift people actually want

Your free gift (often called a lead magnet) decides how many people join your list. The best gifts solve one specific problem quickly, not everything at once.

Gifts that work well

- A one-page checklist ("7 things to set up before your first funnel")
- A short guide or cheat sheet that answers one question
- A template or swipe file they can copy, such as social posts or email subject lines
- A short video training or recorded webinar
- A free tool or system, which is exactly what DFY Funnels lets you give away

Four tests before you use it

1. **Specific:** the title promises one clear result.
2. **Quick:** it can be read or used in under 15 minutes.
3. **Relevant:** it leads naturally to what you will offer later.
4. **Useful on its own:** it helps even if they never buy anything.

In DFY Funnels, you attach the gift as an Incentive and it is delivered automatically on opt-in. In Systeme.io, you deliver it from the thank-you page or the first email.

Write follow-up emails people open

Good follow-up emails sound like a helpful friend, not an advertisement. Teach first, sell second, and keep each email to one idea.

A simple five-email welcome sequence

Day	Email	Purpose
0	Here's your free gift	Deliver what you promised, say who you are
1	My story	Why you started and the problem you solved
3	A quick win	One tip they can use today
5	The common mistake	What holds most people back, and the fix
7	An invitation	Your offer, with a clear reason to act

After the welcome sequence, keep sending one helpful email a week so your list remembers you.

Tips that lift open rates

- Write short, curious subject lines ("The mistake I made for two years").
- Use the reader's first name. Both platforms insert it for you.
- Keep emails short enough to read on a phone.
- End with one clear link, not five.
- Send from your own name, not a company name.

Stay on the right side of email law

Only email people who opted in, include your mailing address, and make unsubscribing easy. This is the core of Canada's anti-spam law (CASL) and the US CAN-SPAM Act, and both platforms handle the unsubscribe link for you.

Where to share your link (free traffic)

A funnel with no visitors collects no leads. You do not need paid ads to start; consistent sharing in a few places beats occasional sharing everywhere.

Place	What to share	Why it works
Pinterest	Pins linking to your free gift	Pins keep sending visitors for months
YouTube	Short how-to videos with your link in the description	Videos are found in search for years
Instagram and TikTok	Reels with a "link in bio" call to action	Short video reaches new people fast
Facebook and LinkedIn	Value posts, then conversations by message	Your existing network already knows you
X (Twitter)	Short tips, with your link pinned to your profile	Steady daily posting builds a following
Your email signature	One line with your free gift link	Every email you send becomes an invitation
Real conversations	Offer the gift when it genuinely helps	Personal invitations convert best

Pick two places and post there every day for 30 days before adding more. DFY Funnels' content library supplies ready-made posts, reels and images for exactly this.

One rule above all: give value before you ask. Spamming links into groups or messages hurts your reputation and can get your accounts restricted.

Your first 30 days: a simple plan

This plan works on either platform and takes about 30 to 60 minutes a day. The goal for the month is a working funnel and your first real subscribers.

Week 1: Set up

- [ ] Open your free account (links at the end of this guide).
- [ ] Decide what you will promote: an affiliate offer, your business, or your own product.
- [ ] Choose or create your free gift.
- [ ] Publish your opt-in page and test it by signing up yourself.

Week 2: Follow-up

- [ ] Load or write your five-email welcome sequence.
- [ ] Send yourself every email and check each link.
- [ ] Add your link to your email signature and social profiles.

Week 3: Traffic

- [ ] Pick your two sharing places.
- [ ] Post once a day in each, using ready-made content where you have it.
- [ ] Reply to every comment and message within a day.

Week 4: Review and improve

- [ ] Check how many people visited your page and how many signed up.
- [ ] If fewer than 1 in 5 visitors sign up, test a new headline or gift.
- [ ] Write your first weekly email to the whole list.
- [ ] Decide what to keep doing next month.

Five mistakes that stall new marketers

Most people who give up did not pick the wrong tool; they made one of these mistakes.

1. **Building forever, launching never.** A simple funnel that is live beats a perfect one that is not. Publish in week one and improve as you go.
2. **Selling before helping.** If every post is a pitch, people tune out. Aim for roughly four helpful posts for every one that asks.
3. **Skipping follow-up.** Most sales come after several emails, not on the first visit. Let your sequence do its work.
4. **Chasing every platform.** Two places done daily outperform six done occasionally.
5. **Quitting in the first month.** List-building compounds. Subscribers you gain this month can still buy a year from now.

The right tool removes the technical barriers. The steady daily habit is what builds the business.

How I help you get started

If you join DFY Funnels or Systeme.io through my links below, I help you get started. Here is what that looks like, so you know exactly what to expect.

Everyone who joins through my links

- A welcome email from me pointing you to the right training for your first steps
- This guide, which covers the funnel basics, free gifts, follow-up emails, traffic and a 30-day plan
- DFY Funnels' live weekly training, with every session recorded and searchable in the members area
- Systeme.io's built-in help centre and step-by-step video tutorials, available from inside your account

Most first questions are answered in those places, and you will usually find the answer faster there than by waiting for a reply.

Paid members

If you upgrade to a paid DFY Funnels plan or a paid Systeme.io plan through my links, you can also email me your questions directly: sir.richabbott@proton.me. I reply within 2 business days - usually sooner.

How to get a fast answer

- Tell me which platform you are using and which page or step you are on.
- Say what you tried and what happened.
- Attach a screenshot if something looks wrong.
- put funnel name in subject line eg. re:DFY

A clear question usually gets solved in one reply instead of three.

Frequently asked questions

Is Systeme.io really free? Yes. The free plan has no time limit and needs no credit card. It includes up to 2,000 contacts, 3 sales funnels and 1 course, with unlimited email sends.

Is DFY Funnels really free? Yes. The basic system is free forever, and new members get 14 days of full access with no credit card. The paid plan is $29.97 a month, waived any month you have three paying referrals.

What is the cheapest alternative to ClickFunnels? For list-building, DFY Funnels is free to start. For selling your own products, Systeme.io starts free and its first paid plan is $17 a month. ClickFunnels starts at $97 a month.

Can I use DFY Funnels to sell my own product? Yes. DFY Funnels can promote any link, including your own product page. It does not process payments itself, so the sale happens on your checkout page, such as a website, Gumroad or Systeme.io.

Does Systeme.io take a cut of my sales? No. Systeme.io charges 0% transaction fees on every plan. Only your payment processor, such as Stripe or PayPal, takes its usual fee.

Do I need technical skills? No. DFY Funnels gives you done-for-you funnels and emails, and Systeme.io uses drag-and-drop builders and templates.

Can I use both? Yes, and many people do. DFY Funnels builds your list and promotes offers; Systeme.io sells and delivers your own products.

Can I earn by recommending them? Yes. Both have referral programs. Systeme.io pays affiliates 60% of every payment for the life of the customer, and DFY Funnels waives your monthly fee once you have three paying referrals.

Get started free

Both platforms cost nothing to try, so the simplest next step is to open an account and look around.

- **DFY Funnels** (free forever, 14 days of full access, no credit card): richabbott.dfyfunnels.pro
- **Systeme.io** (free plan, no credit card): Start your free Systeme.io account

Disclosure: the links above are my referral links. If you join or upgrade through them, I may earn a commission at no extra cost to you. I use both platforms in my own business.

A note on prices

All prices were checked on each company's own website on October 28, 2026, and are shown in US dollars. Plans and prices change, so confirm the current price when you sign up.